

4.2 2D Animation Tools

4.2.1 UIRA

Increasing frustration over the lack of a Flash authoring tool for Linux eventually led to the starting of the Flash4Linux (F4L) project, which (predictably) got itself embroiled in legal issues regarding the name. The project shut down, and in its place rose UIRA (UIRA Isn't a Recursive Acronym), which also took some cues from the another project called QFlash. The project is still in beta, and ActionScript (Flash's native programming language) support is a little shaky, so as long as you stick to making basic SWF animations without programming, you shouldn't run into much unpleasantness. The interface is built to be similar to Flash to make the transition easy, and it lets you import SVG files (the ones you create in Inkscape, perhaps?) for your animations.

Site: www.uira.org

4.2.2 Synfig

Once an in-house solution for professional 2D animators, Synfig went open source when Voria Studios, its parent company, went bankrupt. While they were in business, however, they did manage to churn out some compelling-looking work, so the release of their tool to the general public was a considerably well-received idea.

Using Synfig is quite like using any vector drawing tool, only you can animate your drawings once you're done with them. All you need to do, really, is define a



Synfig's "professional" intentions seem quite clear